

University of Nottingham - Author Guide

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Adobe

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University of Nottingham - Author Guide

This guide is for content authors and content managers working on the University of Nottingham website, built on **Adobe Experience Manager Sites Edge Delivery Services** and authored in the **Universal Editor**. It reflects the current state of the project and supersedes any earlier version.

Quick Reference

Resource	URL
Universal Editor (authoring)	Open a page from AEM Sites and click Edit to launch the Universal Editor
AEM Author (content source)	https://author-p151992-e1858597.adobecloud.com
Preview (main)	https://main--nottingham-ac--polizzaetano.aem.page/
Live (main)	https://main--nottingham-ac--polizzaetano.aem.live/
Feature branch preview	https://{branch}--nottingham-ac--polizzaetano.aem.page/

This is a **crosswalk** project: content is authored in AEM Sites using the Universal Editor and delivered through Edge Delivery Services. Content lives in the AEM author repository (not in Document Authoring / DA), so you author visually on the page rather than in a document.

Site

Site	Content Source	Preview	Live
nottingham-ac	AEM Author (author-p151992-e1858597.adobecloud.com)	https://main--nottingham-ac--polizzaetano.aem.page/	https://main--nottingham-ac--polizzaetano.aem.live/

Getting Started

Access Requirements

- ☐ AEM Sites author access (request from your administrator)
- ☐ Universal Editor permissions for the nottingham-ac content tree
- ☐ Preview / publish permissions

Your First Edit

1. Sign in to AEM Sites.
2. Navigate to the page you want to edit in the Sites console.
3. Click **Edit** to open the **Universal Editor**.
4. Select any component on the page to edit its text, images, and links in the properties panel.
5. To add a block, use the + (insert) control inside a section and pick a block from the component list.
6. **Preview** your changes, then **Publish** when ready.

Content Organization

Site Structure

Content is organized as a page tree in AEM Sites. Delivered sections of the site include:

- **Homepage (/)** — built on the `carousel-landing-page` template.
- **Study With Us family** — `study-with-us`, `find-uon`, `pgstudy`, `international-applicants`, `degree-apprenticeships`, `fees-and-funding`.
- **Open Days (/study/campus-visit/open-days)** — built on the `hero-content-page-8` template.
- **study/home** — study landing page.

Languages

The project is currently **single-language (English)**.

Brand & Design System

The design system is reconciled against the University of Nottingham brand. Colours, fonts, and button styles are applied automatically by the blocks and section styles — you choose content and emphasis, not raw colours.

Colour Palette

Token	Hex	Use
Navy	#10263b	Dominant background and text
Deep Navy	#18194f	Stat panels, overlays
Gold	#deb406	Accent, stat-panel highlight
Cream	#faf6ef	Light section band
Pink (CTA)	#d7336c	High-impact call-to-action
Grey	#f3f4f5	Light surface
Light Blue	#009bc1	Extended accent (used sparingly)
Turquoise	#37b4b0	Extended accent (used sparingly)
Purple	#792d85	Extended accent (used sparingly)
Red	#b91c2e	Extended accent (used sparingly)

Typography

- **Headings:** Lora (serif display).
- **Body:** Circular (sans-serif).

Buttons & CTAs (Important — styled by link emphasis)

Buttons are created from **links**. There is **no colour picker** — the button style is chosen entirely by how you format the link text. All buttons render automatically as rounded pills (68px radius).

Format the link as...	Renders as	When to use
Bold	Primary button — navy pill	The main action on a section
<i>Italic</i>	Secondary button — outlined navy pill	Supporting / alternative action

<i>Bold + Italic</i>	Accent button — high-impact PINK pill (#d7336c)	The single most important action only (e.g. “Apply now”, “Book your place”)
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In the Universal Editor: select the link text and apply the formatting from the text toolbar — **Bold** for primary, **Italic** for secondary, and **both Bold and Italic** for the pink accent button. Use the pink accent **sparingly** — one high-impact action per page or section.

Blocks

Blocks are the reusable building blocks of every page. Insert them from the component list inside a section in the Universal Editor. The project currently ships **27 blocks** (including header and footer).

Available Blocks

Block	Purpose	Notes
header	Site header and main navigation	Site-wide; loaded automatically
footer	Site footer	Site-wide; loaded automatically
hero	Standard page hero (heading, text, image)	General-purpose banner
hero-minimal-dark-2	Minimal hero on a dark navy background	Simple dark banner
hero-card-dark	Dark hero with an overlapping content card	Image field uses the DAM asset picker (reference component)
hero-video-dark	Dark hero with a video	Does not autoplay — clicking play opens a modal video overlay . Image (poster) field uses the DAM asset picker . Used on study/home
carousel-hero-dark	Full-width hero carousel on dark	Rotating hero slides
carousel-events-light	Events carousel on a light background	Promote events
carousel-minimal-dark-withimg-5	Minimal 5-item image carousel on dark	Image-led carousel
cards	General-purpose card grid	Flexible content cards
cards-icon-light	Icon feature cards on light	Feature / benefit lists with icons
cards-logos-light	Logo / partner grid on light	Display partner or accreditation logos
cards-nav-light	Navigation cards on light	Link users to key destinations
cards-promo-light	Promotional cards on light	Promo content on a light band
cards-promo-dark	Promotional cards on dark	Promo content on a navy band
cards-promo-light-withimg-3	3-up promo cards with images on light	study/home
cards-promo-dark-withimg-4	4-up promo cards with images on dark	study/home. Image field uses the DAM asset picker
cards-minimal-dark-withimg-5	Minimal 5-up image cards on dark	Image-led card row
cards-ranking-gold	Ranking / stat cards with gold accent	Highlight rankings and key stats
cards-steps-light	Numbered step cards on light	Step-by-step guidance (Open Days light block)
columns	General-purpose columns layout	Can now contain any other available block
columns-withimg-light	Columns with image on light	Open Days light block
columns-video-light	Columns with video on light	Text alongside a video

columns-minimal-dark-withimg-2	Two-column layout with image on dark	Dark split layout
nav-anchor-light	In-page anchor navigation on light	Jump-links within a long page (Open Days light block)
search-course-light	Course search	Course finder / search entry point
fragment	Reusable content fragment	Reference shared content across pages

Notes on specific fields: - The image field on hero-video-dark, cards-promo-dark-withimg-4, cards-promo-light-withimg-3, and hero-card-dark uses the **DAM asset picker** (a reference component) — pick images from AEM Assets rather than uploading inline. - hero-video-dark **does not autoplay**; visitors click play to open a **modal video overlay**.

- The **column block** can contain any other available block —

build composite layouts by placing cards, heroes, carousels, or other blocks inside a column.

Page Templates

Templates control the overall layout of a page. The template is applied through page metadata / page properties (the `template` value). Delivered templates in use include:

Template	Purpose	How to Apply
carousel-landing-page	Landing pages with a hero carousel — used for the homepage	Set the page's template to carousel-landing-page
hero-content-page-8	Hero + content page — used for the Open Days page (/study/campus-visit/open-days)	Set the page's template to hero-content-page-8

Additional templates exist in the project's importer catalog for other page types across the wider site (for example other hero-content-page-* and carousel-landing-page-* variants). Use the same template your page type already uses; when in doubt, copy an existing page of the same type.

Publishing Workflow

Environment	Domain	Purpose
Preview	.aem.page	Review changes before going live
Live	.aem.live	Production site

Workflow: Edit in the Universal Editor → **Preview** → review on the .aem.page URL → **Publish** → change is live on the .aem.live URL.

Common Tasks

Task	Steps
Create a Page	In the Sites console, create a page under the correct parent → open in Universal Editor → set the template in page properties → add sections and blocks → set title/description → Preview → Publish
Edit a Page	Open page in Universal Editor → select a component → edit text/images/links → Preview → Publish
Add a Block	Inside a section, use the insert (+) control → choose a block from the list → fill in its fields

Add a Button/CTA	Add or select a link → format the link text: Bold (primary), Italic (secondary), Bold+Italic (pink accent)
Update Navigation	Edit the header content → Preview → Publish
Update Footer	Edit the footer content → Preview → Publish
Build a composite layout	Insert a columns block → inside a column, insert any other block (cards, hero, carousel, etc.)

Sections and Section Styles

Sections group content on a page. In the Universal Editor, each section can be given a style via its section properties.

Available section styles:

Style	Effect
highlight	Cream band background (#faf6ef) with padding
light	Cream light band (#faf6ef)
dark	Navy background (#10263b) with white text and links

Dark sections automatically switch headings, links, and text to white for contrast.

Page Metadata

Property	Required	Purpose	Example
title	Yes	Page title for SEO and the browser tab	"Open Days"
description	Yes	SEO / social description	"Book your place at a University of Nottingham open day."
image	No	Social sharing image	Selected from AEM Assets
template	No	Applies a page template	carousel-landing-page

Images and Media

Method	How
AEM Assets (DAM)	Blocks with a DAM asset picker (hero-video-dark, cards-promo-dark-withimg-4, cards-promo-light-withimg-3, hero-card-dark) reference images directly from AEM Assets
Inline image field	Other image fields let you select or upload an image for that component

Best practices: use descriptive filenames, always add alt text, and let the platform optimize delivery automatically. Videos on hero-video-dark open in a modal overlay on click (no autoplay).

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
Page not updating after publish	Wait 1–2 minutes for cache, then hard refresh (Cmd/Ctrl+Shift+R)
Button shows wrong colour/style	Check the link's text formatting — Bold = primary, Italic = secondary, Bold+Italic = pink accent
Block not displaying correctly	Confirm all required fields are filled and you inserted the intended block variant

Image not showing	Verify the asset is selected from AEM Assets and the reference is valid
Wrong page layout	Check the template value in page properties matches the intended template name exactly
Video plays unexpectedly	hero-video-dark never autoplays; the video only opens in a modal after clicking play

Resources

Resource	URL
Universal Editor docs	https://www.aem.live/docs/ue-authoring
Authoring overview	https://www.aem.live/docs/authoring
Edge Delivery Services docs	https://www.aem.live/docs/
Markup, sections & blocks	https://www.aem.live/developer/markup-sections-blocks

Support Contacts

- Project administrator: gpolizzi@adobe.com
- Add your internal content team contacts here.